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Eng digs in on the T's rough week

'I hope that people don't judge us on one storm'

SHIRLEY LEUNG

COMMENTARY

Phil Eng says he feels our pain: the delays, cancellations, and unshoveled parking lots and access points at T stations that have greeted MBTA riders all week as the region digs out from the biggest snowstorm in years.

The general manager of the T is a regular Blue Line rider, and has been on the Orange, Green, and Red Lines this week too. Just like us, he has experienced longer than usual commutes. While he puts much of the blame for this week's slowdowns on decades-old trains and signals, he said that's no excuse for



SHIRLEY LEUNG/GLOBE STAFF

On Tuesday, Red Line commuters had a crowded ride in the morning because of disabled trains.

what commuters are going through.

And it has been bad, even triggering for those of us who endured the MBTA's collapse during the winter of 2015 when the region endured more than 100 inches of snow in a few weeks.

This week, Red Line riders like myself were stuck on a train for more than an hour and some commuter rail users were beset by delays and cancellations. Service disruptions extended into the Thursday evening commute, as the system continued to struggle with snowy tracks and frigid temperatures.

Eng asks for patience and to remember how far the T has come in the nearly three years he has been at the helm.

"This one storm should not be

LEUNG, Page A7

Healey calls for steps to curb ICE

Would ban agents from schools, churches, courts

By Samantha J. Gross and Anjali Huynh

GLOBE STAFF

Governor Maura Healey put forward a bill Thursday that would ban federal immigration enforcement from entering churches, schools, courthouses, and other sensitive locations in Massachusetts.

The action, which mirrors parts of legislation already proposed by some members of the Legislature, comes after advocates in the state have urged Beacon Hill leaders to protect immigrants and implement any restrictions they can on ICE agents.

"People have been killed," Healey said at the State House. "Others have been shot. You see mothers and fathers ripped out of cars and from the arms of their children. United States citizens have been stopped, arrested, and detained."

While Healey has been sharply critical of the Trump administration's immigration policies, she's also faced criticism for not taking swifter action to protect immigrants. In September, California Governor Gavin Newsom signed an executive order to block ICE from classrooms and hospitals. In October, a county commission in Illinois blocked county property resources from being used by ICE in Chicago.

Healey said the legislation proposed Thursday is meant to address the feeling of instability

HEALEY, Page A6

'ICE and Customs and Border Patrol will continue their normal operations that have been ongoing here for many years.'

SENATOR SUSAN COLLINS

Maine wary about news ICE surge in state is over

By Lea Skene and Jim Puzzanghera

GLOBE STAFF

PORTLAND, Maine — Maine residents, immigration advocates, and community leaders expressed cautious optimism Thursday following an announcement from Senator Susan Collins that the federal government has ended its recent immigration enforcement surge in the state.

But others raised questions about the political forces at play, including Collins's high-profile reelection campaign and increasing pressure on the Trump administration after federal agents killed two American citizens in Minneapolis during protests against an immigration crackdown there.

Dubbed "Operation Catch of the Day," the Maine initiative has ensnared over 200 immigrants since it began last week, leaving communities on edge and inciting outrage among residents who disagree with the Trump administration's mass deportation agenda. Despite the administration's claims it is targeting "the worst of the worst," agents have arrested Maine residents with pending asylum claims and valid work permits.

Collins said Thursday that Department of Homeland Security Secretary Kristi Noem informed her, "ICE has ended its enhanced activities in the state of Maine."

"ICE and Customs and Border Patrol will continue their normal operations that have been ongoing here for many years," Collins said in a statement. "I will continue to work with the secretary on efforts to end illegal immigration, drug smuggling,

MAINE, Page A6

AG sues towns for refusing to comply with housing law

By Andrew Brinker

GLOBE STAFF

In a major escalation of the fight over more housing in Massachusetts, Attorney General Andrea Campbell on Thursday sued nine towns for refusing to comply with the MBTA Communities Act, the controversial state law that requires 177 municipalities served by the T to make room for more multifamily residences.

Campbell said the nine towns — Dracut, East Bridgewater, Halifax, Holden, Marblehead, Middleton, Tewksbury, Wilmington, and Winthrop — have had more than enough time to comply with the five-year-old law, and shouldn't be allowed to evade their responsibilities when so many others in the state have complied.

"While bringing a lawsuit is never my first choice, courts have consistently ruled that compliance with this law is mandatory, and the urgency of our housing shortage compels me to act to ensure that all MBTA Communities meet their legal responsibilities," she said in a statement.

While passed under then-governor Charlie Baker, the MBTA Communities Law has become a cornerstone of Governor

MBTA COMMUNITIES, Page A7

We're not ready for her close-up

Mass. is cold to 'Melania' documentary on big screen

By Mark Shanahan

GLOBE STAFF

Are you excited to see "Melania"? Not "Moana" — "Melania," the new documentary about first lady Melania Trump.

The consensus, in most parts of deep-blue Massachusetts, is an emphatic no. But don't be surprised if the movie, which arrives in theaters Friday, manages to find an audience among supporters of President Trump.

According to the apparatchiks at Amazon MGM Studios, which paid \$40 million for the rights to the movie and another \$35 million to market it, the documentary follows Melania Trump in the 20 days leading up to her husband's second inauguration. Viewers are invited to "step inside Melania Trump's world as she orchestrates inauguration plans, navigates the complexities of the White House transition, and reenters public life with her family."

If you're wondering what critics think of "Melania," they weren't allowed to see it before its release, which generally isn't a sign of an Oscar winner. The film's rollout also comes at a complicated time. Given the tragic events in Minneapolis and ongoing ICE actions in Maine and elsewhere, the public appetite may be limited for an adoring portrait of a first lady who once



THOMAS COEX/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

wore a jacket emblazoned with "I really don't care, do you?" to visit a migrant child detention center.

Yet on the same day ICU nurse Alex Pretti was shot to death by federal agents in Minneapolis, the White House hosted a black-tie screening of "Melania" for a select group of CEOs, including Tim Cook of Apple, Amazon's Andy Jassy, AMD's Lisa Su, and Zoom chief Eric Yuan, as well as former boxer Mike Tyson, Queen Rania of Jordan, Erika Kirk, and self-help guru Tony Robbins. (Guests were given commemorative popcorn boxes, cookies bear-

MELANIA, Page A4

President Trump said President Vladimir Putin had agreed not to target the Ukrainian capital for a week because of extreme cold. **A3.**

Ex-Boston community organizer Monica Cannon-Grant

was sentenced to four years probation and six months of home confinement. **B1.**

Patriots quarterback Drake Maye said he felt "good" amid reports he has a right shoulder injury. **C1.**



Going under

Friday: Wicked cold. High 14-19. Low 2 to -3.

Saturday: A little better. High 20-25. Low 9-14.

Weather and Comics, **G6-7.**

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